The Tree Beyond the Trees

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 3, Episode 1

Lookout Hill's invitation lay beside a borrowed guide. The woodland post route was working behind you; the complete old map and moonstone remained at camp. On the hill path, Nib chose the first convenient tree. Lark compared its rounded crown with the forked silhouette in the guide. They were plainly different trees.

“A tree is a tree,” Nib declared hopefully. “This word asks us to see a particular one,” Lark replied gently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **stamp**

“Two e letters can work together for the long e sound,” Lark modeled clearly. “Read see and seed with one vowel sound for ee. Compare the short e in pen. In tree, blend the beginning sounds together before adding ee.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try see, seed, feet, tree. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read tree in the route key,” Lark invited gently. “Which distant silhouette matches the whole guide clue?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **Sam can see. Pat can see tree tops.**

“What can Pat see?” Lark asked gently. “Read all the words after can.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

From a broad viewing stump, the forked tree showed above the near canopy. Lark traced the correct path in the guide. Nib stepped away from his convenient trunk and followed the useful direction instead. At a supply shelter, the lookout's glass fittings waited in padded storage. They had found the route without inventing a new map.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write see beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark drew the two tree shapes on your first hill journal page. The guide stayed with the crew. The next job was bringing the waiting glass and its small fittings uphill in one piece.

The Jammed Jar

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 3, Episode 2

At the supply shelter, tiny fixing pieces rested inside a clean reused jar. Its lid was jammed. Nib twisted until the whole jar turned in his paws. Lark put a padded tray beneath it before the little fittings could be tipped onto the floor.

“A jar with a very firm opinion,” Nib muttered suspiciously. “Let us give it a gentler suggestion,” Lark urged.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **see**

“Lowercase j begins jam and job,” Lark modeled clearly. “Make its one quick voiced sound, /j/, without an extra vowel. Join j, a, m for jam. The word can describe what is happening here even though this jar holds fittings rather than a picnic spread.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try jam, jet, jog, job. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read the short job label,” Lark invited gently. “Then use the supplied diagram to choose pressing and lifting instead of tipping.”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **Sam can jog. Pat can get jam.**

“Who can get jam?” Lark asked warmly. “Which friend has the different job?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

The jar rested in the tray's padded recess. Nib pressed the stiff catch and lifted the lid while Lark held the tray steady. No little pieces spilled. They sorted the fittings into separate shallow spaces and closed the tray. A larger glass pane still waited nearby; that load needed a wheeled carrier rather than a mouse carrying everything at once.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write j beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal showed the jar sitting safely in its recess. Outside the shelter stood a small woodland delivery van with space for a padded load. The fittings were ready to travel with the glass.

The Van with the Wrong Load

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 3, Episode 3

Two crates waited beside the delivery van. Nib loaded the largest first. When its lid lifted, velvet flags spilled over the edge. The glass pane remained in a smaller padded tray on the shelter floor. Lark unfolded the reserved-load strip from the lookout guide.

“Very valuable velvet flags,” Nib announced eagerly. “Very useful glass,” Lark replied firmly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **jam**

“For v, touch top teeth to lower lip and add your voice: /v/,” Lark modeled clearly. “For f, the air flows without that voice. Compare van and fan. Our new v keeps its voice as we join it into van and vest.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try van, vet, vest. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read van on the reserved-load strip,” Lark invited gently. “Which pictured load does that whole strip assign to our journey?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **Sam can get it. Pat can not.**

“Which friend cannot get it?” Lark asked gently. “Read the whole second sentence.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib returned the decorations to the shelter. The glass tray settled into the van's padded supports, with the fittings secured separately beside it. Lark checked that neither could slide across the other. The correct load was smaller and considerably more useful. The van reached a covered stopping place just as a shower began.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write v beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark recorded the actual load, then supplied the little missing spoken words when rereading the journal together. The glass was safely uphill, but its case cover stopped short of the lower edge. The rain had found the next practical question.

A Cape for the Case

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 3, Episode 4

The glass case rested beneath the stopping-place roof. Nib wrapped a spare cover around it until even the handle disappeared. It was beautifully covered and impossible to carry. Rain brushed the roof edge while Lark laid the guide open where it stayed dry.

“A cape of considerable elegance,” Nib declared. “A handle of considerable usefulness,” Lark observed warmly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **van**

“Compare cap and cape,” Lark modeled clearly. “In cape, a and the final silent e work across the middle consonant to give a its long sound. Tap becomes tape the same way. The little word a is special: here we say it softly, /uh/, before a name for something. We'll learn that word explicitly, too.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try cape, tape, make, a. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read tape on the fitting note,” Lark invited gently. “Where does the diagram leave room for the handle?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **Sam can make a cape. Pat can tape it.**

“What can Pat do after Sam makes the cape?” Lark asked warmly. “Use the second sentence.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib opened the unnecessary top fold. Lark held a fitted cloth cape around the case while he fixed its lower edge with tape. The rain could run off, and the handle stayed free. They tested a short lift before returning the covered case to its padded place. At the narrow approach ahead, a short stopping note waited.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write cape beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

The journal picture showed both the dry case and its usable handle. Nib carried the light guide while the van brought the covered glass onward. The next support was visible, but not ready to cross.

The Yes That Meant Yet

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 3, Episode 5

Nib saw the first letters of a stopping note and brightened. The van waited behind him on broad ground. Ahead, one fastening on the crossing support was still loose. Lark put a wing beside the very last letter before Nib could call the route ready.

“Yes!” Nib exclaimed. “Yet,” Lark corrected gently, pointing to the very last letter.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **cape**

“At the beginning of yes and yet, y has its consonant sound,” Lark modeled clearly. “Join it to e and s for yes. Now change only the last sound to t: yet. The beginning doesn't tell us enough to choose between them.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try yes, yet, yap. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read the final word on our stopping note,” Lark invited gently. “Does it say yes, or yet?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **Sam can yap. Pat can not nap yet.**

“Who cannot nap yet?” Lark asked gently. “What is Sam doing in the other sentence?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

The longer message, supplied by Lark, was not yet. Nib stayed behind the support while its visible fastening was secured. Lark checked the supported boards, and the van crossed slowly only when the load path was ready. On the far side, a duck greeted you beside the next marker with an enthusiastic quack.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write y beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal kept the two ending letters side by side. The load was safely across, and waiting had finished its useful job. Nib listened to the duck's greeting without pretending it was permission for the next turn.

A Quack Beside the Path

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 3, Episode 6

The duck quacked beside two sheltered notes. One marked a rest bay; the other showed the direct path to the hill lodging. Nib nodded politely at every quack and nearly turned in three directions at once. Lark held the guide still so the printed clue could have a turn.

“Very clear quacking,” Nib insisted politely. “A useful word is clearer still,” Lark murmured.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **yes**

“Here qu writes the two familiar sounds /k/ and /w/ close together,” Lark modeled clearly. “Blend them into quack and quick. It isn't the letter name, and it isn't one new sound. Queen uses the ee team we already met.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try quit, quick, quack, queen. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read quack on the route label,” Lark invited gently. “Match it to the duck marker, then check where its path leads.”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **Sam can quack. Pat can quit.**

“Which friend can stop?” Lark asked warmly. “Find the word that tells you.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

The duck marker belonged beside the direct lodging path. Nib waved goodbye and followed the note rather than the loudest greeting. The van reached a level parking space below the hill lodging. The covered glass and fittings were intact. A fixed lifting frame stood beside the platform above, ready for the final part of their journey.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write quack beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark drew the duck's marker and the lodging turn. Nib parked the van before studying the lifting frame. The correct path was found, and now the glass needed a proper lifting attachment.

The Rope at the Hill Home

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 3, Episode 7

At the hill lodging, Nib looped a rope around the cloth cape. Lark stopped the lift before the cloth took the weight. The case rested securely below the fixed frame. Its real load points were visible beneath the handle, exactly where the guide's sling diagram showed them.

“A strong cape,” Nib suggested hopefully. “A stronger place to hold it,” Lark urged calmly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **quit**

“In rope and note, o and final silent e give the vowel its long sound,” Lark modeled clearly. “Compare hop with hope, then read rope. We don't use a long o every time we see o; the spelling of the whole word helps us choose.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try rope, home, note. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read rope on the proper sling's label,” Lark invited gently. “Which attachment points does the guide give it?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **Sam can get a rope. Pat can make a note.**

“Who can record something in writing?” Lark asked gently. “Which word tells you?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib moved the loop from the cover to the case's load points. They raised it a small distance, checked the sling, and lowered it once before the full lift. The frame brought the glass onto the fixed platform intact. The cape stayed a cover. Unfortunately, the packing box's opening now faced the platform rail.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write rope beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

The journal showed the sling beneath the case rather than squeezing its cape. Lark parked the lifting gear. The glass had reached its destination safely; opening the supported box would take one more careful look.

The Box Facing Backward

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 3, Episode 8

Nib lifted the packing lid a little. Its hinge caught against the platform rail. He lowered it without forcing the wood. The box was perfectly good, but it faced the wrong way. Lark put the guide beside it so both hinge arrangements could be compared.

“A box with its back in the way,” Nib complained mildly. “A box we can turn,” Lark replied brightly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **rope**

“At the end of box, x represents /k/ followed by /s/,” Lark modeled clearly. “Two sounds, one letter here. Read box, fox, and six, keeping those ending sounds close. Don't insert an extra vowel between them.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try box, fox, six. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read box on the fitting diagram,” Lark invited gently. “Which side needs clear space for the lid?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **Sam can fix a box. Pat can see a fox.**

“Who sees an animal?” Lark asked softly. “Which final word gives you that clue?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

They turned the supported box until its hinge matched the diagram. Nib opened the lid fully without touching the rail. Lark and the caretaker fitted the glass into its prepared frame. The empty packaging stayed on the platform floor. A flexible ventilation strip lay beside its groove, ready to fit before the lantern was lit.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write box beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal showed the same box in a more useful position. Nothing had needed breaking. The glass now belonged to the lantern's frame, and the next small fitting would help air pass through its vent.

The Zigzag Strip

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 3, Episode 9

The ventilation strip stopped halfway along its zigzag groove. Nib pulled. Its fold tightened. Lark held the strip loosely against the platform so they could inspect the bend without another tug. The new glass stood protected in its frame beside them.

“It has a very zigzag opinion,” Nib muttered suspiciously. “Let us follow the bend,” Lark suggested gently.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **box**

“Lowercase z makes the voiced buzz in zip,” Lark modeled clearly. “Now these familiar-looking s letters need explicit attention: in is and has, s also says /z/. Join each word with that sound. This doesn't change the s in sit into a buzz.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try zip, zap, is, has. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read is and has on the checking strip,” Lark invited gently. “Then use the groove picture to decide whether to follow its bend or pull straight.”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **Sam has a box. A red zip is on it.**

“Where is the red zip?” Lark asked gently. “Use the two sentences together to explain what it means.”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib eased the trapped fold backward. Together they followed the groove's actual zigzag, settling one catch at a time. The strip fitted without stretching, and air could pass through the fixed vent. Lark marked that job complete. The window still needed aligning to its intended direction.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write zip beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark drew the strip following its groove. Nib tested the vent once more and left it alone. Across the platform floor, several old scratches competed with one proper reference line.

The Line Across the Floor

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 3, Episode 10

Nib chose the longest scratch on the platform floor. If the window followed it, the lantern would point straight into the roof. Lark checked the guide. Its reference ran from the window post to a fixed floor peg, a much shorter line with a much more useful destination.

“A very long line,” Nib declared. “The right line,” Lark replied with quiet determination.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

zip

“Compare pin and pine,” Lark modeled clearly. “The final silent e helps i make its long sound in pine and line. The pronoun I is a whole word with that same long sound; it means the person speaking. We'll read it explicitly before using it.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try line, pine, time, I. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read line in the guide,” Lark invited gently. “Which line joins the two fixed points in its diagram?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **I can see a pine. Sam can see a line.**

“What can Sam see?” Lark asked gently. “Which sentence names him rather than the speaker?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib put his paw beside the fixed peg. Lark aligned the window frame to the matching reference. The intended path now led out toward the community meeting place, rather than into the roof. They secured the frame. When the shutter moved, a connecting ring rattled against its pin and stopped the motion short.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write line beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal recorded the fixed peg as well as the line. Nib left the old scratches where they were. The window's direction was settled; the loose ring was now the one remaining reason the shutter could not move smoothly.

The Ring That Rang

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 3, Episode 11

The connecting ring made a pleasant little clang. Nib tested it again, enjoying the note until the shutter stopped halfway open. Lark showed him where the retaining pin had slipped from its proper seat. The music had come from a joint that needed fastening.

“A ring that rings,” Nib observed delightedly. “A ring that stays on,” Lark reminded him warmly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **line**

“In ring and sing, ng writes the single sound /ng/,” Lark modeled clearly. “Keep the ending smooth. Don't add a separate hard g after it. Compare pin and ring, listening to how their endings differ.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try ring, sing, long, king. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read ring on the joint note,” Lark invited gently. “Which fastening belongs to that ring?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **I can sing. Sam has a ring.**

“Who has a ring?” Lark asked softly. “Does the passage say that both people have one?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib held the unloaded ring still while Lark seated the retaining pin. They tested one small shutter movement. The ring stayed connected, and the shutter completed its travel without a clang. The caretaker brought the next fitting: a long tube meant to carry an ordinary signal chime toward the meeting place.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write ring beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark drew the secured joint. Nib listened to its new silence with approval. The shutter worked; the chime still needed a tube that pointed toward the people who were meant to hear it.

The Tune in the Tube

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 3, Episode 12

Nib heard a beautiful note through the newly fitted tube. Outside, Lark heard almost nothing. The open end faced the wall. The fitting had made a splendid private concert for one mouse, while the meeting place remained quiet.

“Excellent music in here,” Nib reported proudly. “We would like some of it out there,” Lark replied with amusement.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **ring**

“In cube and mule, u with final silent e can say /yoo/,” Lark modeled clearly. “In flute it says /oo/. Tube may have either familiar pronunciation in ordinary speech. We'll model the word as we say it here, then join its parts without changing its meaning.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try cube, mule, tube, flute. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read tube on the fitting note,” Lark invited warmly. “Which way does the open-end picture face?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **Sam has a tube. I can make a tune.**

“What does Sam have?” Lark asked gently. “What can the speaker make?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

They loosened the supported fitting and turned the open end toward the listening area. Nib secured it while Lark checked the diagram. One short chime now reached the meeting place. The tube stayed fixed to its bracket; no mysterious sound source had appeared. A cloth shade still covered part of the light window.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write tube beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Your journal showed sound traveling through the ordinary open tube. The chime was ready. Lark kept the lantern unlit while the shade's snag was inspected beside the new glass.

The Shade That Would Not Shift

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 3, Episode 13

The cloth shade caught at the edge of its channel. Nib began to push beside the glass, then noticed how little room his paw had. Lark found the shade's own handle in the guide picture. It was meant to move the shade without pressing on the pane.

“A shade with a stubborn edge,” Nib whispered suspiciously. “A handle with a useful job,” Lark replied calmly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **cube**

“In shut and shade, s and h work together for one /sh/ sound,” Lark modeled softly. “Don't split the team into /s/ and /h/. Join sh, u, t for shut. Shade keeps the long a pattern we already know.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try shut, ship, shop, shade. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read shut on the guide strip,” Lark invited gently. “Which handle does its picture give the shade?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **I can shut a box. Sam can see a ship.**

“Who can see a ship?” Lark asked gently. “Which sentence describes closing something?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Lark freed the little catch while Nib used the proper handle. The shade slid through its clear channel without scraping the glass. The caretaker lit the ordinary lantern inside its fixed housing. The crew left the shutter shut until the agreed signal was ready. Vent, frame, ring, tube, and shade now each did their own job.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write shut beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark drew the clear channel and safe handle. Nib kept his paw away from the glass. The lantern was prepared, and the invitation still held the simple signal the neighbors were waiting for.

My First Beacon

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 3, Episode 14

The invitation lay open beside the completed lantern. It asked for one steady light and one short chime to mark the community gathering. Nib looked from the working fittings to the waiting meeting place. Every small repair had helped make this final signal possible.

“My first beacon,” Nib whispered proudly. “Our neighbors’ useful light,” Lark added warmly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **shut**

“At the ends of my, by, and fly, y can say long i,” Lark modeled clearly. “That is a different job from y at the start of yes. Read these whole words, then revisit lift, shut, and tap on our prepared instruction strip.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try my, by, fly. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read the agreed signal instructions,” Lark invited warmly. “Which job opens the light, and how many chimes does the invitation ask for?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **I can fly by a pine. My ring is in a box.**

“Where is the ring?” Lark asked gently. “Which sentence tells us, rather than telling us about flying?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib used the prepared handle while the shade lifted. Steady light reached the aligned window. One short chime followed. At the meeting place, a flag waved in reply. The signal had reached its intended readers and listeners. After the gathering, the borrowed guide returned to its keeper. A brass star badge and an ordinary viewing lens joined the explorer kit.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write my beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark bound The Long Path and carried it home to the library. The fixed lantern stayed useful on Lookout Hill. A separate Storyboat invitation arrived with returning visitors. The hill adventure was complete before a new voyage began.